

■ Experience Creep

■ What is it?

When products slowly become too complex.

Over time, products that started simple and easy-to-use can get cluttered with extra features, options, or updates.

For example, you may love a new app for its simplicity, but after a few updates, the added features make it overwhelming and less enjoyable to use.

■■ History

The idea of **experience creep** comes from studies of **feature creep** in product design.

As companies compete and listen to customer requests, they often add more features. While the intent is good, the result is a **loss of simplicity**—the very thing that made users love the product in the first place.

■ The Psychology Behind It

- People are easily **overwhelmed by too many options**.
- More features don't always mean more value—they can reduce usability.
- Even small additions (extra buttons, help tips, or icons) can break the clean flow of a product.

The paradox: giving users more choice can make them feel less satisfied.

■■ Why It Matters

Experience creep can lead to:

- User overload and confusion
- Increased frustration
- Decreased efficiency
- Lower engagement
- Missed opportunities for loyalty and growth

■ How to Apply It

- **Limit features** → focus on what truly matters.
- **Simplify navigation** → reduce clutter.
- **Remove unused features** → declutter with updates.
- **Use feedback loops** → learn what users value most.
- **Educate users** → provide simple tutorials and onboarding.
- **Announce updates wisely** → use pop-ups or messages to guide, not overwhelm.

■ Theory in Action

- **Notion** keeps onboarding simple by showing only essential options first, preventing new users from feeling overwhelmed.
- **Instant noodle brands** keep instructions minimal—just a few clear steps to get the best result.

■ Final Thought

New features help products grow, but adding too much can destroy the original simplicity.

Great UX is about **balancing evolution with clarity**—making sure products stay useful, not cluttered.